Foreign Policy

- First Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru has significantly contributed to India's foreign policy.
- Nehru strictly kept the foreign affairs under his control
- Some of the major legacy of Nehru is Panchsheel agreement, Non-alignment policy.

Panchsheel Agreement

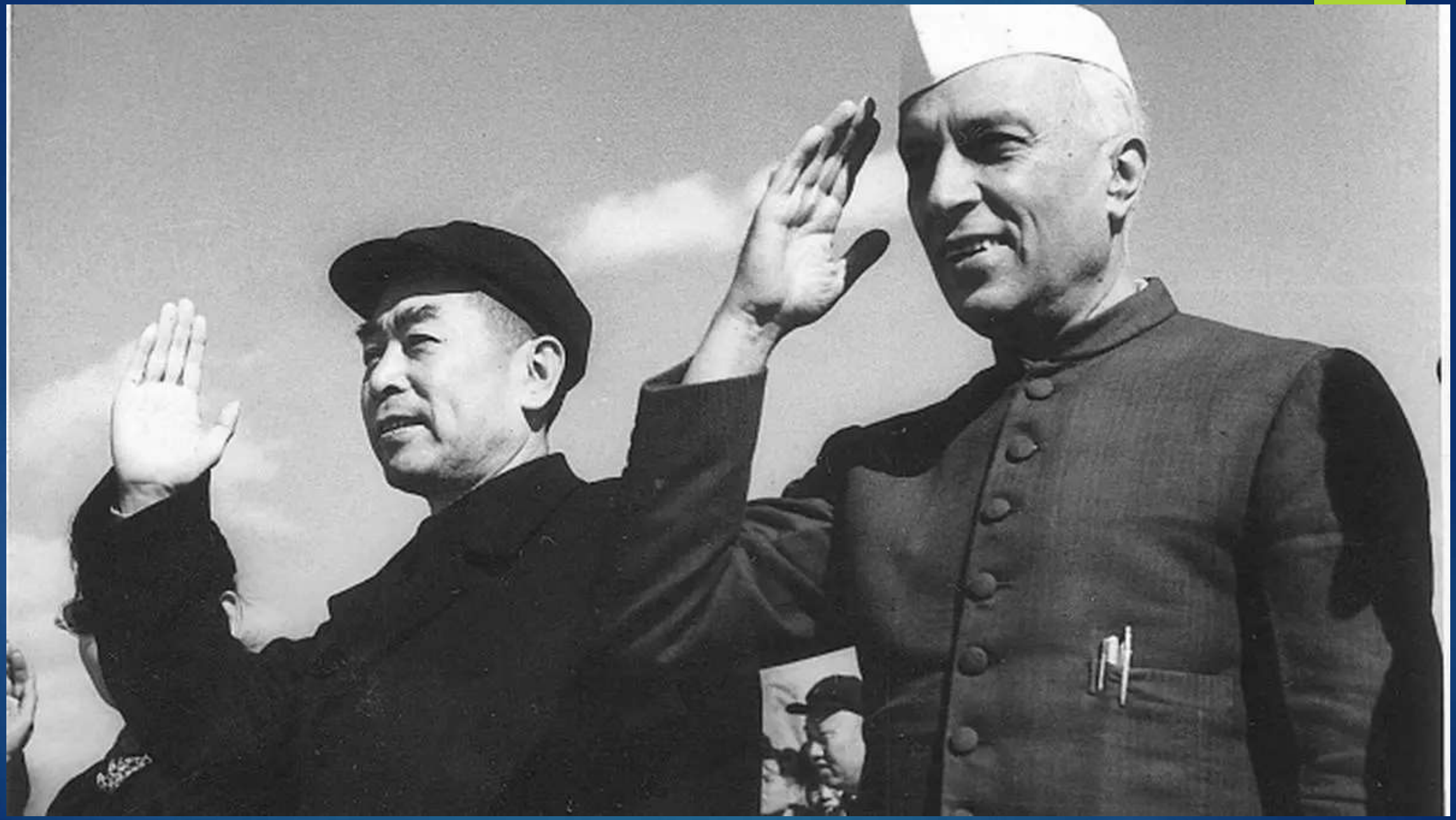
At the time of India's independence, the relationship between India and China was not as bitter as it has been since 1962.

Since America favoured Pakistan at that time, India thought it is good to keep friendly relations with its neighbour China.

This is the reason that India did not strongly oppose China while it was attacking Tibet.

Indian relations with China started worsening when India had given shelter to spiritual leader Dalai Lama in 1959.

- So what is Panchsheel?
- The Panchsheel, or Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence, was first formally signed on April 29, 1954, between India and the Tibet region of China.
- The agreement was signed between then Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and China's first Premier (Prime Minister) Chou En-Lai.



- In April 1954, India, considering Tibet as part of China, entered into an agreement with China on the principle of 'Panchsheel'.
- The main points of the Panchsheel agreement were;

1. Peaceful co-existence

2. Mutual respect for each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty

3. Mutual non-interference

4. Mutual non-aggression

5. Equality and mutual benefit

- After these treaties, trade, and confidence-building between India and China had gained a lot of strength.
- Meanwhile, slogans of the Hindi-Chinese brother were also raised.

KYRGYZSTAN
TAJIKISTAN
EAST TURKESTAN
AFGHANISTAN
PAKISTAN
TIBET
PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA
NORTH KOREA
NEPAL
BHUTAN
INDIA
BANGLADESH
MYANMAR
VIETNAM
LAOS

Although the immediate Prime Minister Nehru tried to make good relations between the India and China through the Panchsheel agreement, however, he did not succeed and the 1962 war took place between the two countries.

Bandung Conference

- Held in 1955 in Bandung

- The core principles of the Bandung Conference were:

Political self-determination,

mutual respect for sovereignty,

non-aggression,

non-interference in internal affairs,

equality

- These issues were of central importance to all participants in the conference, most of which had recently emerged from colonial rule.
- The governments of:

Burma,

India,

Indonesia,

Pakistan,

Sri Lanka

co-sponsored the Bandung Conference, and they brought together an additional twenty-four nations from Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

- Because the decolonization process was still ongoing, the delegates at the conference took it upon themselves to speak for other colonized peoples (especially in Africa) that had not yet established independent governments.

SYRIA
SUDAN
SAUDI ARABIA
PHILIPPINES
PAKISTAN
LIBYA
LIBERIA
LEBANON
JORDAN
JAPAN
IRAQ
IRAN
INDONESIA
INDIA
GOLD COAST
ETHIOPIA

INDONESIA
INDIA
GUINEA

- The Bandung Conference and its final resolution laid the foundation for the nonaligned movement during the Cold War.
- Leaders of developing countries banded together to avoid being forced to take sides in the Cold War contest.

Non Aligned Movement

- Non-Aligned Movement (NAM), international organization dedicated to representing the interests and aspirations of developing countries.
- The Non-Aligned Movement emerged in the context of the wave of decolonization that followed World War II.
- At the 1955 Bandung Conference (the Asian-African Conference), the attendees, many of whose countries had recently gained their independence, called for "abstention from the use of arrangements of collective defense to serve the particular interests of any of the big powers."

- In the context of the Cold War, they argued, countries of the developing world should abstain from allying with either of the two superpowers and should instead join together in support of national self-determination against all forms of colonialism and imperialism.

- The Non-Aligned Movement was founded and held its first conference in Belgrade in 1961 under the leadership of:

Josip Broz Tito of Yugoslavia

Gamal Abdel Nasser of Egypt

Jawaharlal Nehru of India

Kwame Nkrumah of Ghana

Sukarno of Indonesia

Nehru, India…Kwame, Ghana….Nasser Egypt….Sukarno, Indonesia….Tito, Yugoslavia

- As a condition for membership, the states of the Non-Aligned Movement cannot be part of a multilateral military alliance or have signed a bilateral military agreement with one of the “big powers”.

- However, the idea of nonalignment does not signify that a state ought to remain passive or even neutral in international politics.

- On the contrary, from the founding of the Non-Aligned Movement, its stated aim has been to give a voice to developing countries and to encourage their concerted action in world affairs.

Israel - Palestine

Israel - Palestine

- India did not subscribe to the partitioning of Palestine plan of 19747 and voted against Israel's admission in the United Nations in 1949.
- Nehru and Gandhi both were pro-Palestine. They opposed the creation of Israel as he was against the creation of countries based on religion.
- India also did not recognize Israel as a nation till 1950. Finally in 1950, India recognized Israel as a nation.
- 1954, Nehru further stated that he would not "be a part to a resolution which stated that the creation of Israel was a violation of international law"

- Following India's recognition of Israel, Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru stated, "we would have [recognised Israel] long ago, because Israel is a fact. We refrained because of our desire not to offend the sentiments of our friends in the Arab countries."

- In 1953, Israel was permitted to open a consulate in Mumbai

- Nehru administration sought Israel's assistance in the India-China war of 1962, and still didn't change the geopolitical relationship between the two countries.

- Nehru created a precedent in obtaining military assistance from Israel without requiring any diplomatic exchange, or even publicly acknowledging the existence of such security assistance.

- From India's recognition of Israel in 1950 to the early 1990s, the relationship remained informal in nature.
- Israel supported India during the Indo-Pakistani War of 1971.
- India's opposition to official diplomatic relations with Israel stemmed from both domestic and foreign considerations.
- Domestically, politicians in India feared losing the Muslim vote if relations were normalized with Israel.

Modi's foreign policy

- India's bold outreach to Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates.

- For far too long, the Persian Gulf did not receive the attention it deserved. Many countries there were viewed as overly supportive of Pakistan for religious reasons and hence left outside of India's priorities

- Recognising, however, the political changes in the Arab world, Modi moved unexpectedly to engage Saudi Arabia and the UAE in ways that promise important political and economic benefits.

- The weakening of the traditional, knee-jerk support for Pakistan is already in evidence, but the longer-term gains derive from the Gulf monarchies' deepening opposition to Islamist terrorism as India continues to struggle against this threat.

- The growing interest in India as an economic opportunity further suggests that the wealthy Arab states will increasingly acquire a stake in New Delhi's success.

- India already remains a major customer of Gulf energy, but as India rises internationally, it will become more important to the region's strategic interests.

- Modi's ability to jumpstart this transformation, while avoiding enmeshment in the current intra-Gulf rivalries and while preserving good relations with Iran, demonstrates an agility that has eluded even the United States.

This is a time for us to engage America, manage China, cultivate Europe, reassure Russia, bring Japan into play, draw neighbours in, extend the neighbourhood and expand traditional constituencies of support.

S. Jaishankar
The India Way: Strategies for an Uncertain World

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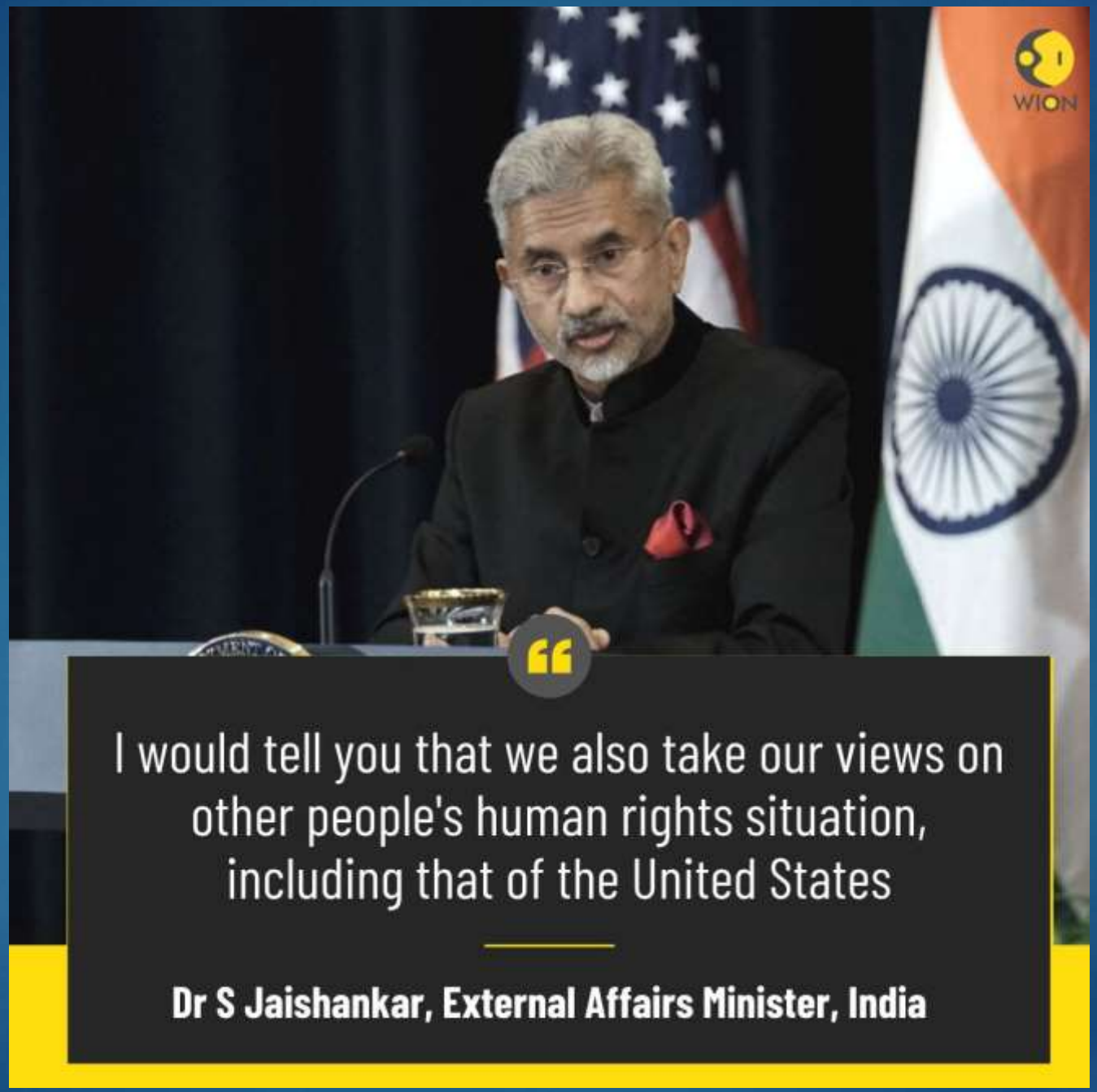
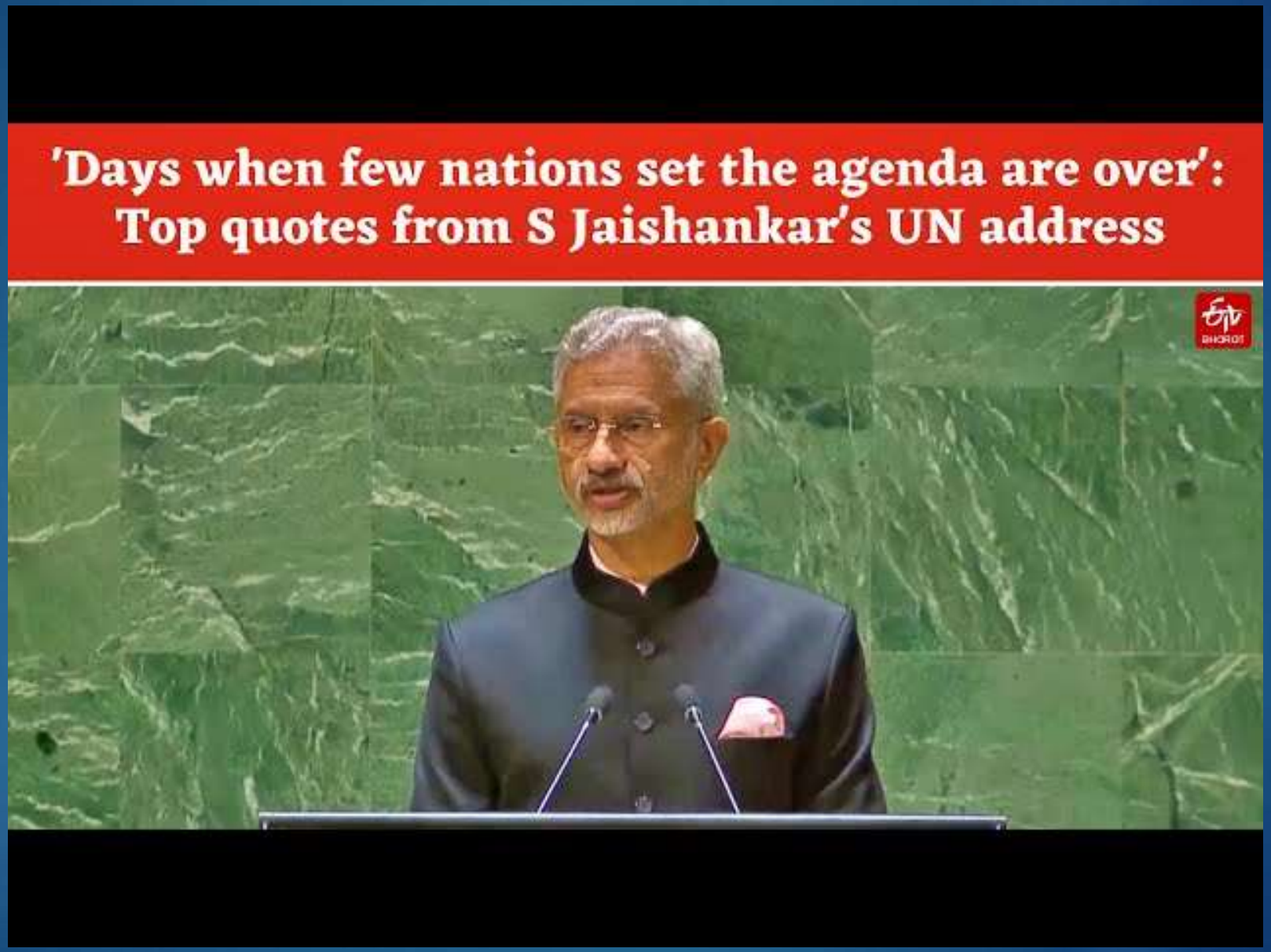
JAISHANKAR CALLS OUT WESTERN
'HYPOCRISY' ON RUSSIAN OIL


WION
I would tell you that we also take our views on other people's human rights situation, including that of the United States
Dr S Jaishankar, External Affairs Minister, India

"EUROPE'S PROBLEMS ARE WORLD'S PROBLEMS BUT WORLD'S PROBLEMS ARE NOT EUROPE'S?"

-Dr. S JAISHANKAR
External Affairs Minister, India


'Days when few nations set the agenda are over':
Top quotes from S Jaishankar's UN address